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José María Palomares Rodríguez

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Compilador: José María Palomares Rodríguez

Editorial DYKINSON, S.L. Meléndez Valdés, 61 – 28015 Madrid
Teléfono (+34)91 544 28 46 – (+34) 91 544 28 69
e-mail: info@dykinson.com
<http://www.dykinson.es>
<http://www.dykinson.com>
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THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN PERSONALITY TRAITS AND ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT IN PSYCHOBIOLOGY COURSE AMONG PSYCHOLOGY UNIVERSITY STUDENTS

MARÍA JOSÉ TORRES PRIORIS*, CLAUDIA PEÑALOZA AND DIANA LÓPEZ-BARROSO*
*UNIVERSIDAD DE MÁLAGA; **UNIVERSIDAD DE BARCELONA**

Academic success is crucial for professional development. Graduate programs in Psychology include biology-related courses that seem challenging for first-year students who often show poor learning performance. Factors including personality traits may impact academic achievement by modulating academic motivation, making it important to identify how personality traits influence academic success in difficult biology-based courses. To assess the relationship between personality traits and academic performance in practical and theoretical assessments of the course "Fundamentals of Psychobiology" in first-year Psychology students. Ninety-four first-year psychology students (age: 21.1 ± 5.9) who enrolled the course "Fundamentals of Psychobiology I" at the University of Malaga (Spain) participated in this study. Students completed the Spanish version of the Big Five Personality Trait Short Questionnaire, assessing five personality dimensions: extraversion, agreeableness, openness to experience, conscientiousness, and neuroticism. Academic achievement was assessed as individual grades on assessments of practical skills and theoretical knowledge of course contents. Two independent regression analyses examined the predictive power of personality traits on each measure of academic performance. Multiple regression models significantly predicted grades in the practical [$F(5, 88) = 3.71, p < .004$] and the theoretical course assessments [$F(5, 85) = 5.86, p < .001$]. The first regression model predicted 17% of the variance on practical evaluation scores with conscientiousness ($t = 3.52; p < .001$) and agreeableness ($t = -2.24; p = .027$) significantly contributing to the predictive model. The second regression model predicted 26% of the variance on theoretical evaluation scores with conscientiousness being the only personality factor that significantly contributed as a predictor ($t = 5.00; p < .001$). Conscientiousness is the personality trait with the most important role in predicting academic success in the theoretical and practical components of the course of Fundamentals of Psychobiology in first-year Psychology students, whereas agreeableness plays a unique role in predicting student success on practical content evaluations.

MOTOR AFFORDANCES SEEM TO BE INVOLVED IN SERIAL MEMORY FOR VISUAL OBJECTS

ANTONIO MARÍN*, EMILIO RAMÓN LÓPEZ NAVARRO, LLUÍS BARCELÓ-COBLIJN** AND HÉCTOR MARÍN MANRIQUE*****

UNIVERSITAT JAUME I; **UNIVERSITAT DE LES ILLES BALEARS; *UNIVERSIDAD DE ZARAGOZA*
Traditionally, serial memory is construed as invoking representation-specific short-term stores operating in concert with some information refreshing mechanism. Here we report a study examining serial memory for visual objects and show that contrary to such modular view, but in line with an embodied perspective, motor affordances influence performance. To examine whether serial memory for visual objects is influenced by type of grip afforded by those objects, more specifically we hypothesized that those lists that include objects that afford the same grip, be it power or precision, are recalled better than those lists that alternate objects that afford a precision grip and objects that afford a power grip. The task was to encode and recall sequences of 6 pictures (6 power grip objects, 6 precision grip objects or mixed 3PW+3PG) in their order of presentation. At the end of the presentation phase, the recall screen appeared, consisting of the entire set of 12 objects presented in a random (different on every trial) arrangement across three rows of four pictures. Participants clicked on the pictures in their original order of presentation. The results are clear-cut: correct serial recall was greater in pure than in alternating lists, an effect mediated by item-related errors. Remarkably, inter-response latencies were longer for alternating than for pure lists, suggesting that motoric transitions afforded by the to-be-remembered lists may constrain serial memory performance. Our results provide evidence of the involvement of motor affordances in visual serial memory and echo previous findings in the verbal domain. Not only motor affordances were elicited by the to-be-remembered objects in our experiment but, more importantly, they constrained their assembly into a sequence. In other words, the effect we reported seemed to emanate from the incompatibility of the motor affordances automatically generated by our stimuli when assembled into a sequence.

SPANISH ADAPTATION OF LAWSON'S PSYCHOLOGICAL CRITICAL THINKING EXAM

**MARTA NATALIA TORRES DOMÍNGUEZ, ITXASO BARBERIA FERNANDEZ AND JAVIER RODRÍGUEZ-FERREIRO
UNIVERSITAT DE BARCELONA**

Critical thinking is an important skill both in the scientific field and in everyday life, crucial to identify anecdotal evidence, unfalsifiable hypothesis, biased data sampling methods, or unreliable causal connections. Nevertheless, there are few specific standardised measures for its assessment.